

Nikki Nasser

nnasser@gmu.edu

Education

George Mason University

August 2026 - Present

- PhD in Information Science and Technology

University of California-Berkeley

August 2025 - May 2026

- M.A. in Learning Sciences and Human Development

University of California-Irvine

September 2023 - June 2025

- B.A in Psychological Science, GPA 3.99/4.00
- Graduated Magna Cum Laude

Irvine Valley College

August 2021 - May 2023

- A.A. in Psychological Science
- Graduated Cum Laude, Dean's list

Grants and Awards

- NSF GRFP Fellow August 2026
- UCI School of Social Ecology Honors Program & Excellence in Research Distinction Award June 2025
- UCI UROP Research Grant, \$251 December 2024
- UCI Summer Undergraduate Research Program (SURP) Research Grant, \$1,500 June 2024
- UCI Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program (UROP) Publication Award, \$1,000 March 2024
- UCI UROP Research Grant, \$500 December 2023

Professional Development

LearnLab Summer School, Carnegie Mellon University

Summer School Participant

July 2026

- Selected through a competitive application process to participate in Carnegie Mellon University's LearnLab Summer School.
- Completed advanced training in the learning sciences, educational data mining, and AI in education through lectures, workshops, and collaborative research activities.

Conference and Academic Presentations

- Siddiqui, M. N., Nasser, N., Coscia, A., Pea, R., & Subramonyam, H. (2026, April 13-17). *DraftMarks: Enhancing Transparency in Human-AI Co-Writing Through Interactive Skeuomorphic Process Traces* [Conference Paper]. Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI). Barcelona, Spain.
- Nasser, N., He, K., & Warschauer, M. (2026, April 8-12). *Comparing Children's Verbal Engagement with an Interactive Media Character and a Human during Video Watching* [Poster & Lightning Talk Presentation]. American Educational Research Association. Los Angeles, CA, United States.
- Nasser, N., He, K., & Warschauer, M. (2026, April 8-12). *Examining Children's Scientific Misconceptions from an Educational Video with an Embedded Conversational Agent* [Poster & Lightning Talk Presentation]. American Educational Research Association. Los Angeles, CA, United States.
- Nasser, N., He, K., & Warschauer, M. (2025, May 1-3). *Verbal Participation of Young Children with AI Conversational Agents and Human Partners* [Poster presentation]. The Society for Research in Child Development. Minneapolis, Minnesota, United States.
- Nasser, N., He, K., & Warschauer, M. (2025, May 27, 2025). *Engaging Young Viewers: Children's Verbal Interaction with AI Characters Compared to Human* [Oral presentation]. UCI School of Social Ecology Honors Collegium. Irvine, California, United States.

- **Nasseri, N.,** He, K., & Warschauer, M. (2025, August 7-9). *How AI Dialogue Clarifies Scientific Misconceptions for Children* [Poster presentation]. American Psychological Association. Denver, Colorado, United States.
- Dastmalchi, N., Youneis, N., **Nasseri, N.,** Wang, R., Luu, J., & Pressman, S. (2024, April 24-28). *Optimizing Recreation: The Relationship Between Different Types of Vacation Activities and Overall Well-Being* [Poster presentation]. The Western Psychological Association. Hyatt Regency San Francisco, San Francisco, CA, United States.
- Younies, N., Dastmalchi, N., **Nasseri, N.,** Wang, R., Luu, J., & Pressman, S. (2024, May 23-26). *Unlocking the Secrets of Vacation Bliss: Exploring the Link Between Well-Being and Vacation Activities – Insights into the Positive Influence of Social Engagement and Calming Pursuits, and the Detrimental Impact of Work-related Activities on Overall Wellness* [Poster presentation]. Association of Psychological Science. Hyatt Regency San Francisco, San Francisco, CA, United States.

Manuscripts in Progress & Preprints

- **Nasseri, N.,** Subramonyam, H., Pea, R., Seifert, C., & Gerstenberg, T. (2025). *Learning by Creating: Investigating Interactive Simulation Building as a Tool for Deeper Understanding* [Manuscript in preparation]. *Journal of Educational Technology*.
- Siddiqui, M. N., **Nasseri, N.,** Coscia, A., Pea, R., & Subramonyam, H. (2025, September 27). DraftMarks: Enhancing transparency in human-AI co-writing through interactive skeuomorphic process traces. arXiv. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2509.23505>

Research Internships

Stanford HAI Institute - Research Intern

June 2025 - Present

PI: Harihan Subramonyam

- **Project:** *Learning by Creating*
 - Led the Learning by Creating project, studying how participants learn through building simulations versus reading texts
 - Designed and obtained IRB approval, recruited participants, and managed study logistics
 - Built a full-stack interactive simulation platform from scratch using React, nodes.js and JavaScript, saving entries and managing versions with Git
 - Deployed app via Heroku
 - Created pre-tests, post-tests, and a post-study survey from scratch to measure learning outcomes and engagement

Independent Research Projects

Children's Verbal Engagement with AI Agents vs. Humans

Digital Learning Lab, UCI

Honors Thesis Recipient

September 2024 - June 2025

- Conducting an honors thesis under Dr. Mark Warschauer on children's verbal engagement with an AI-powered interactive character versus a human during video watching
- Developed metrics to analyze children's verbal engagement, including their response rate, length, accuracy, relevance, and intelligibility
- Performed regression analysis to compare children's response to an AI agent versus a human co-viewer, controlling their baseline language proficiency and science knowledge
- Disseminated findings to the SRCD conference and the UROP symposium in 2025

The Relationship between Vacation and Well-being

Stress, Emotion, & Physical Health Lab, UCI

Grant Recipient

June 2024 - May 2025

- As a first author on UROP poster investigated the relationship between how different types of leisure activities during vacations impact subjective well-being
- Conducted Pearson correlation and multiple regression analyses to examine the relationship between vacation activities and well-being outcomes such as stress, happiness, and sleep quality
- Analyzed self-reported sleep quality and Fitbit sleep data to explore the relationship between vacation activities and sleep quality
- Presented findings at the UCI UROP Symposium in 2024

Children's Scientific Misconceptions from Educational Media

Independent Undergraduate Researcher

Digital Learning Lab, UCI

July 2024 - December 2024

- Developed a coding scheme of five categories of misconceptions through a literature review
- Analyzed children's responses to post-test assessments in R to identify and calculate the percentage distribution of each scientific misconception category
- Provided design implications for more effective science television shows to improve educational outcomes
- Disseminate future directions for media developers to design educational content that minimizes misconceptions in children's media.
- Introduce the idea of integrating AI conversational agents to media developers to enhance learning experiences in children's programming.

Undergraduate Research Experience

Digital Learning Lab - Research Assistant

February 2024 - June 2025

PI: Mark Warschauer

- Project: *Converse to Learn*
 - Developed scoring rubrics and scored children's response to post-test assessments to evaluate their learning from science narrative videos
 - Analyzed scoring discrepancies among team members using Excel, fostering discussions to achieve consensus on children's responses
 - Examined AI agents' performance by comparing how AI agents and human researchers classify children's responses
 - Transcribed children's verbal engagement during interactions with a human co-viewer, categorizing responses to ensure consistent analysis of engagement with different learning agents

Stress, Emotion & Physical Health Lab - Research Assistant

June 2023 - June 2025

PI: Sarah Pressman

- Project: *Wearable Technologies to Assess Physiology, Emotions & Reward Seeking Behaviors*
 - Developed and refined study procedure scripts, materials, and training guides to standardize research practices.
 - Trained and mentored new undergraduate research assistants on lab protocols and procedures.
 - Edited and designed psychological surveys to ensure clarity and accuracy in data collection.
 - Conducted study sessions involving stress-inducing experimental procedures for data collection.
 - Implemented ecological momentary assessment (EMA) procedures to evaluate daily behaviors.
- Project: *Stress, Emotion and Energy (SEE) Facial Coding*
 - Transcribe and organize data from Noldus Facereader software into structured Excel spreadsheets, ensuring data accuracy and consistency
 - Analyze, clean, and organize HRV and impedance data through Excel software functions
 - Contribute to the development of research ideas and insights based on data collected
 - Disseminated research findings and insights to project leaders and team members
- Project: *SEE COVID Facial Coding*
 - Convert participants ZOOM interview to Noldus Facereader to properly code facial expressions
 - Transfer coded facial expression data to excel spreadsheet and initiate data coding and cleaning
 - Communicated project progress and research findings to project managers and team members

Teaching Experience

Psychology Honors Thesis Seminar - Graduate Student Tutor

August 2025 - Present

- Held weekly office hours for a class of 20 students, providing one-on-one guidance on all aspects of their honors thesis projects
- Assisted with research design, literature reviews, data analysis, and interpretation of results
- Reviewed and provided feedback on writing, including drafts, APA formatting, and results presentation
- Advised students on research ethics, study planning, and milestone management to ensure timely thesis completion

Positive Psychology - Learning Assistant

January 2025 - Mar 2025

- Organized virtual office hours for individual student consultations regarding course material or academic support needs, with my knowledge in the psychology course
- Deliver feedback using positive reinforcement techniques to encourage, motivate and build confidence in students.
- Responded promptly to student emails, assisting with course material and assignments while collaborating with the professor to address concerns and answer questions
- Facilitate discussion boards among students to encourage collaboration, critical thinking, and problem solving skills

Media & Public Engagement

Featured Guest- UCI UROP Researcher Roundup Podcast

May 2025

- **Episode:** “Fake News!” –Discussed the research process as a UCI undergraduate by designing a hypothetical study to test a satirical scientific claim and reflecting on how research works
- Selected to represent UCI’s undergraduate research community and promote research accessibility for diverse audiences
- Shared experiences as a student researcher and encouraged research engagement through science communication

Skills

- Tools and languages: R, Full-Stack Development, Deployment, Git, JavaScript, React, SPSS, JASP, Excel
- Data analysis techniques: T-test, ANOVA, multiple regression, correlation, factor analysis
- Languages: Farsi (native), English (native), Spanish (intermediate), Russian (beginner)